

CHINA STRATEGY

AI Changes The Game: Correction, Rotation, and Diversification

China strategy
AI changes the game
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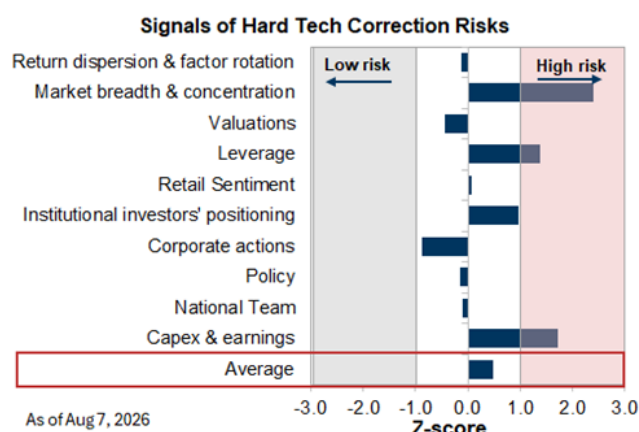
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After a strong first-half in which AI Hard Tech proxies rallied 33% on average in our defined Chinese AI equity universe, they have experienced a significant pullback from their June peaks alongside the sharp reversal of the global AI trade, with **STAR50, ChiNext, and CSI1000 correcting 20%+ from their recent highs**. In this edition of our AI Changes The Game series, we present 10 indicators/signals on market pricing, risk appetite, flows, positioning, policy, and fundamentals to assess the tactical risk and reward for Chinese AI Hard Tech equities and to gauge the maturity of the correction cycle.

Bottom-line: a decent portion of the prior speculative length, valuation excess, leverage, and positioning crowdiness in the AI Hard Tech trade has been taken out in the latest drawdown, but we think likely elevated market volatility in the near term warrants continued focus on uncorrelated assets within and outside of the Chinese AI ecosystem. Key strategies and ideas for diversification and idiosyncrasy: a) scaling into select H-share Internet/Soft Tech; b) policy beneficiaries such as GS 15FYP Portfolio and **domestic- vs export-oriented AI names**; c) **oversold non-tech stocks with earnings upgrades**; and, d) **alpha in the IPO market and cash returns**.



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

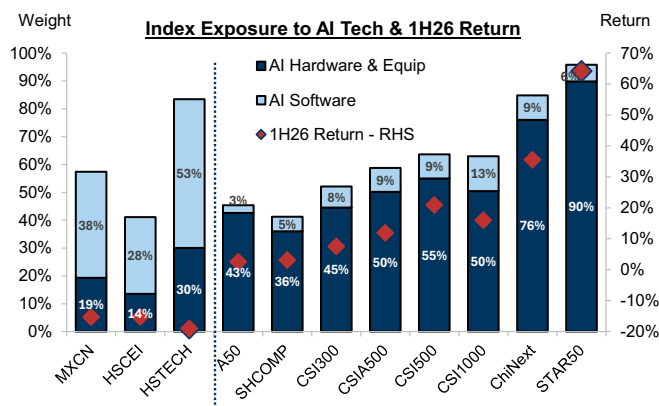
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Where are we in the AI (Hard Tech) correction cycle? 10 indicators/signals we are watching

1) Return dispersion and factor rotation

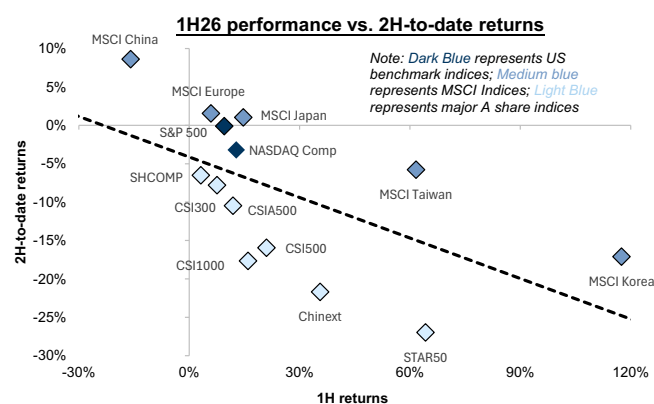
As detailed in our recent reports ([Asia](#), [China](#)), inter- and intra- **return divergence across regional markets, sectors, and themes surged to unprecedented levels in 1H26**. In China, the principle factor driving the spreads was the AI Hard vs Soft Tech divide, as exemplified by the 100%+ relative return gap of STAR50 over HSTECH in the first 6 months of the year, matching the peaks in early 2021 when dispersion skyrocketed during the Covid-related stimulus rally. Generally, dispersion tends to rise when market beta and investors' risk appetite improves, with Size (small) and Growth (high) often leading in a bull cycle. However, the outperformance of these pro-cyclical styles has corrected sharply alongside the unwind of the AI Hardware trade globally in the past month, and has now returned to the long-term averages for Soft Tech (vs. Hard Tech) and even at fairly extreme levels for Momentum and Size, suggesting to us that **the velocity of the drawdown and style/factor rotation should start to moderate** from a price momentum perspective.

Exhibit 1: Indexes with higher AI Hardware exposures significantly outperformed in 1H



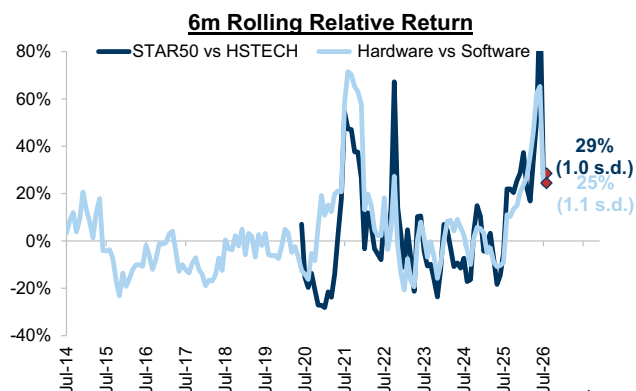
Source: FactSet, MSCI, HSI, CSI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Prior outperformers have given back a significant portion of their 1H gains since July



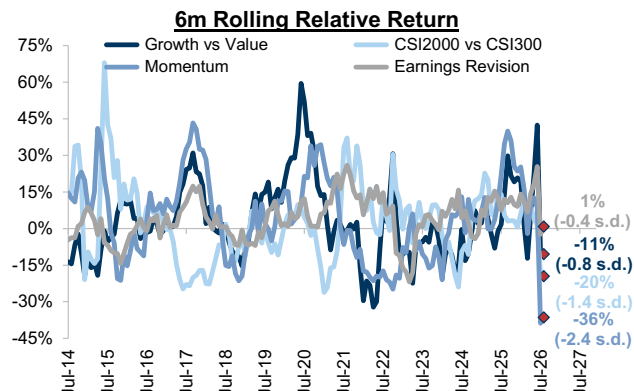
Source: FactSet, MSCI, HSI, CSI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: A sharp reversal of the Momentum, Hard Tech, and Size factors in the past month



Source: Factset, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Momentum, Size, and Growth have seen deeper corrections in the past few weeks

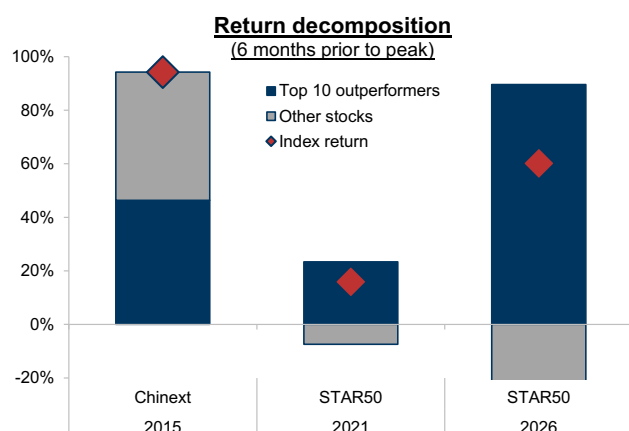


Source: Factset, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

2) Market breadth and concentration

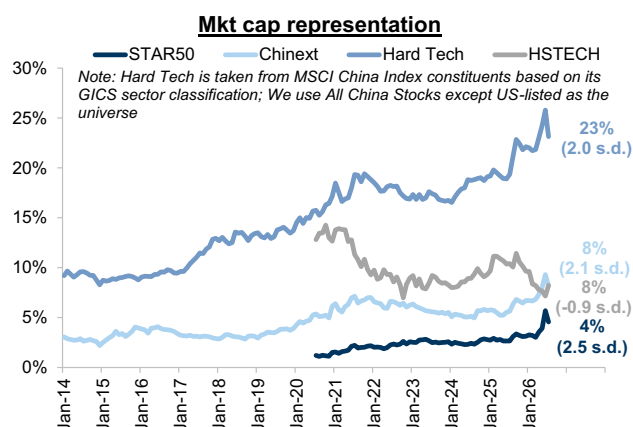
Concentration risk manifests in many facets in the equity universe, and we focus on market cap/return, volume, and factor concentration for the purpose of this study. On returns, **90% of STAR50 returns ytd are contributed by top-10 outperformers**, vs. 23% in early 2021 and 46% for ChiNext in mid-2015. The concentration of returns is also reflected by the rising market cap representation by Hard Tech equities in A-share benchmarks, most notably in the ChiNext and the STAR universes. Similarly, volume concentration has risen to recent-year highs, with the tech sector, ChiNext, and STAR50 representing 26%, 14%, and 6% of total cash turnover in the A-share market. Pairwise correlation (average correlation of all stock pairs), an indicator measuring to what extent the market is trading macro forces (high correlation) or idiosyncratic micro themes (low correlation), shows that the latter, most likely **AI and Tech**, remains the dominant theme among investors across the China equity universe.

Exhibit 5: Return concentration in the latest correction episodes is comparable to that in previous major market downturns



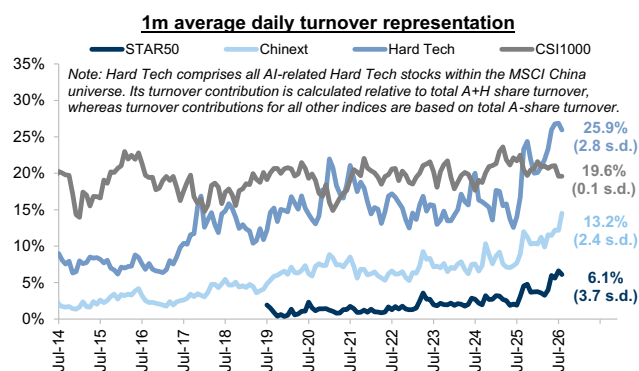
Source: Factset, Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Return contribution/concentration has dropped significantly in HK, but remains high in A shares



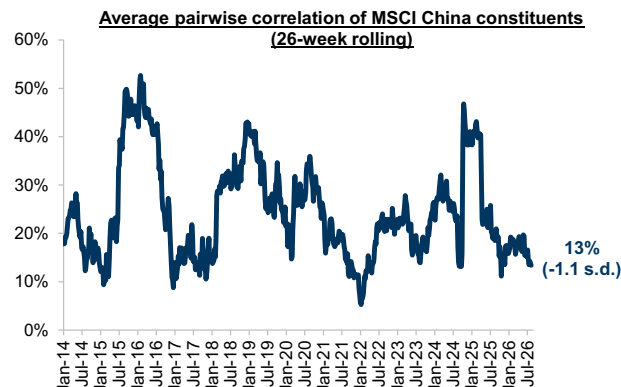
Source: Wind, Factset, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: Turnover contribution stays elevated for A-share Hard Tech and small/mid caps



Source: Wind, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: Stock return correlations are still at recent-year lows, implying that AI remains the dominant driving force of equity returns

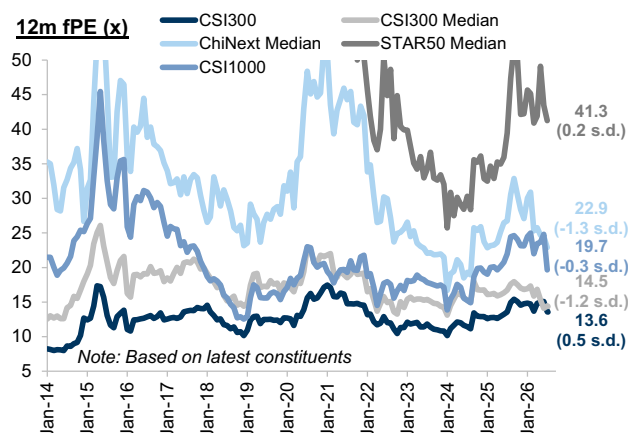


Source: MSCI, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

3) Equity multiples and valuations

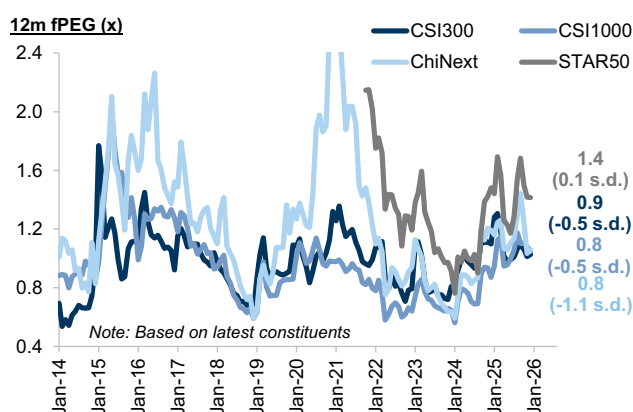
Valuations recently climbed to local highs for A-share (hard) tech companies, with ChiNext trading at 26x fP/E on a cap-weight basis and STAR50 commanding 50x fP/E at the median stock level at their respective peaks in June. The de-rating since then has pushed the **equity multiples of A-share Hard Tech companies down to or below their long-term averages**, especially on a PEG basis when their growth potential is taken into account. That said, valuations are arguably rich for STAR50 names on an absolute scale, and A-share names across Chinese AI ecosystem have closed their valuation (discount) gaps vis-a-vis their global peers post the latest global AI selloff, implying to us that **valuation risks have lessened, but are far from entirely discounted/removed**.

Exhibit 9: Headline index valuations for A-share Tech companies have normalized



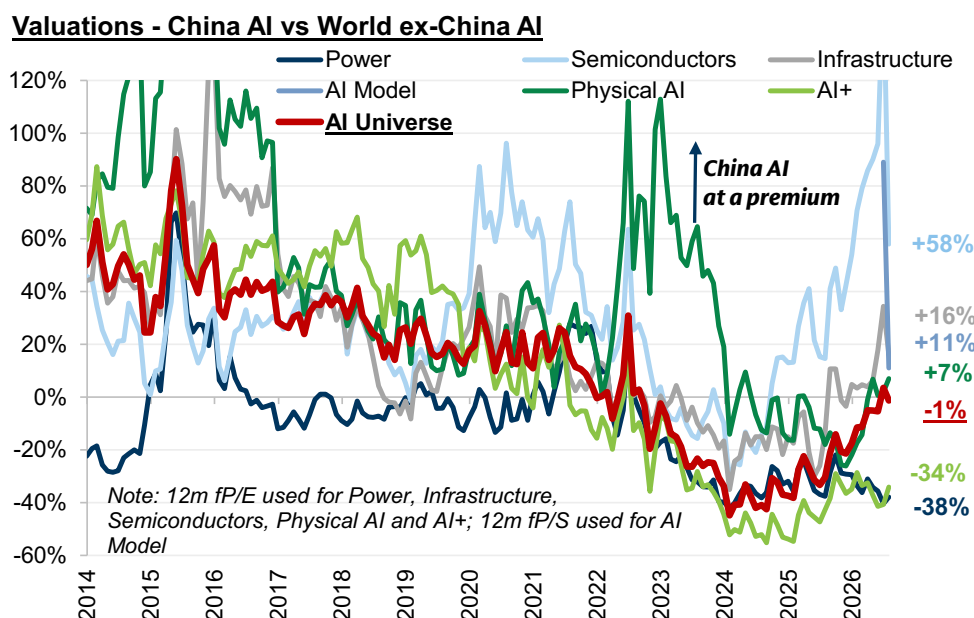
Source: FactSet, I/B/E/S, CSI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: Forward PEG ratios are at or below mid-ranged levels



Source: Wind, Factset, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: Valuation discounts of Chinese AI proxies have narrowed vis-a-vis their global peers



Source: FactSet, IBES, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

4) Leverage in the stock market

Margin financing balance remains the most transparent and timely proxy for levered exposures in A shares as leveraged ETFs (or leveraged fund products) are not allowed in the onshore equity market. Aggregate margin balance and its representation in free-float market cap have both retreated from their all-time highs (now to Rmb2.6tn and 5.5% of free-float market cap, down from Rmb3tn and 6.0%), but still above their historical norms, suggesting that the de-leveraging cycle, if it continues, could be still at its early stages compared to the ones in Korea and Taiwan. However, the **effective system-wide leverage at present**, encompassing uncollateralized consumer loans, offshore-listed leveraged ETFs, and other equity-linked structured products (e.g. snowball derivatives) of which data is not well populated, should be **meaningfully lower than the peak in 2015** when off-balance-sheet borrowing was prevalent among individual investors. **One area of concern is the concentration of leverage in AI Hard Tech**, where top-10 percentile of stocks currently make up of 30% of the total outstanding margin balance, the highest ever.

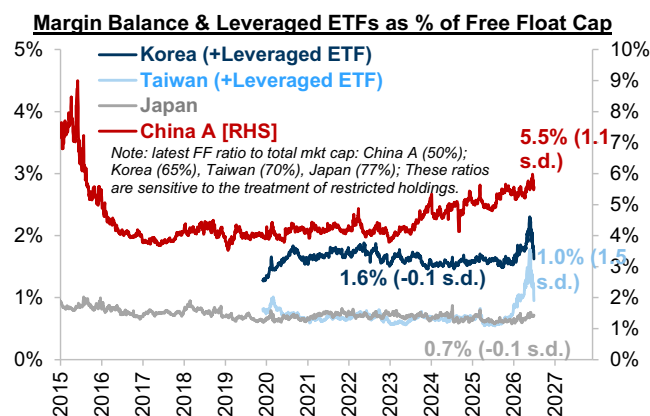
Exhibit 12: Margin leverage requirements comparison table

Market	Leveraged ETFs		Stock margin trading				
	Underlyings	Leverage (on local exchanges)	Minimum Initial Margin Requirement (in Equity to Total Market ratio [^])	Max Leverage	Maintenance Equity%	Grace Period	Liquidation Mechanism
A-shares	N/A	N/A	50% (equivalent to 100% Collateral Ratio ^{^^} , raised from 80% in January 2026, applying only to newly opened margin contracts); ETFs also eligible for margin trading	2.0x	~23% (implied from 130% Maintenance Collateral Ratio)	T+1; Some brokers may add a tighter "instant liquidation line" at 110% or 115% Collateral Ratio	Forced liquidation at T+2 if the ratio is not restored to above 150%
Hong Kong	Indices and overseas single stocks (currently expanding to non dual-listed HK stocks)	Within +/-2.0x (Dynamic leverage allowed since Aug 2026)	No regulatory requirements; In practice varying by stock (20%-60%; typically 30% for liquid blue chips)	3.3x	Varying by stock/broker (typically 15% for liquid blue chips)	Broker discretion	Broker discretion
Taiwan	Indices	Within +/-2.0x	40% (Listed stocks)	2.5x	~23% (implied from 130% Maintenance Collateral Ratio)	T+2	Forced liquidation at the market open on T+3
Korea	Indices and single stocks (onshore single-stock ETFs launched May 2026)	Within +/-2.0x ^{^^^}	40% (Base rate; brokerages dynamically adjust based on stock liquidity and volatility)	2.5x	~29% (implied from 140% Maintenance Collateral Ratio)	T+1 midnight	Forced liquidation at the market open on T+2
Japan	Mainly indices	Within +/-2.0x	30% (with a minimum account equity requirement of JPY 300,000)	3.3x	20% ([^] Equity to Total Market Value Ratio; some brokers set internal limits at 25% or 30%)	T+1	Forced liquidation at the market open on T+2

Note: [^]Equity to Total Market Value Ratio = $\frac{\text{Equity Value}}{\text{Market Value of All Margined Positions}}$; ^{^^}Collateral Ratio = $\frac{\text{Collateral Value}}{\text{Margin Loan}}$; ^{^^^}FSC is seeking emergency powers to lower to 1.5x or suspend during periods of high volatility.

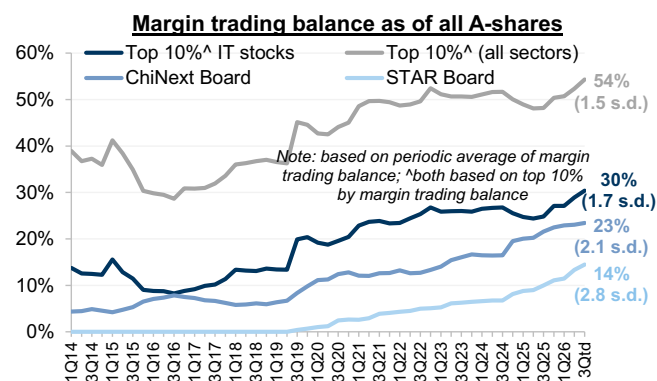
Source: CSRC, TWSE, HKEX, KRX, JPX, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: Margin financing balance has remained stable in A shares while Korea and Taiwan have experienced sharp de-leveraging in the past month



Source: TEJ, TWSE, JPX, Wind, Bloomberg, Korea Financial Investment Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: Leverage concentration in A-share Tech stays elevated

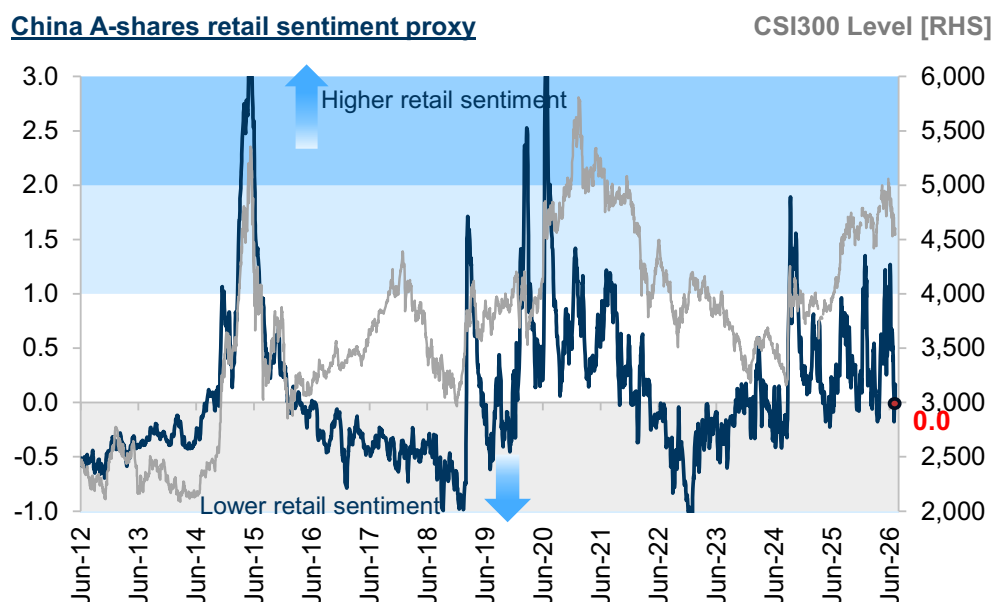


Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

5) Retail investors' sentiment

In 2025, we introduced a barometer to measure the risk appetite of retail investors who account for 70% of average daily turnover in A shares despite the gradual rise of institutional sponsorship led by domestic mutual, pension, and insurance funds. Besides margin financing statistics, the barometer sums up 11 other high-frequency indicators such as new investor accounts, IPO subscription statistics, and turnover velocity across the speculative length, equity allocation, trading propensity categories to forge a more complete picture on local investor sentiment. Our barometer currently stands at 0 s.d. relative to the past 1-year range, correcting from ~1 s.d. from a month ago, pointing to **neutral to somewhat subdued risk appetite among A-share individual investors**.

Exhibit 15: A-share retail sentiment has quickly deteriorated in the past month



Source: Wind, CSF, SSE, SZSE, SIPF, ICBC, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: Our China A-share retail sentiment proxy comprises 13 inputs that span across 4 key categories

Inputs to China A-shares Retail Sentiment Proxy		Unit	Frequency	Since	Source	Current value	Past 1Y z-score
Speculative length	Margin trading balance	RMB bn	D	2012	CSF	2605	0.0
	Margin trading balance as % of A-shares FF mkt cap	%	D	2014	CSF	5.5	0.3
	# of limit up as of total listed A-shares	%	D	2012	Stock Exchanges	1.6	0.1
Equity allocation	Small & mid cap ETF flows	RMB bn	D	2023	Wind	17.0	2.8
	Thematic ETF flows	RMB bn	D	2023	Wind	1.3	0.1
	New deposits in past 3M: non-bank fin vs. households	RMB bn	M	2015	PBoC	2720	1.2
	New equity mutual fund issued	# shares mn	D	2012	Wind	1638	-1.0
Trading	Total turnover	RMB bn	D	2012	Stock Exchanges	2662	0.4
	Turnover velocity	x	D	2012	Stock Exchanges	13.9	0.1
	Small & mid order flows	RMB bn	W; D	2015	Wind	-5926	-2.8
	IPO retail subscription ratio	x	D	2012	Wind	4578	0.2
Propensity	New account opening	# mn	M	2012	SSE	2.7	-0.4
	Online search index	#	D	2012	Baidu	-1.0	-0.6

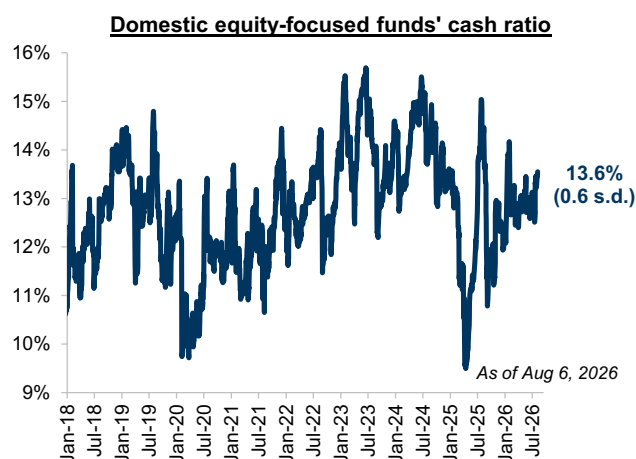
Note: SDMA of the median of past 1Y z-scores is taken to calculate the retail sentiment proxy

Source: Wind, CSF, SSE, SZSE, ICBC, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

6) Institutional investors' positioning

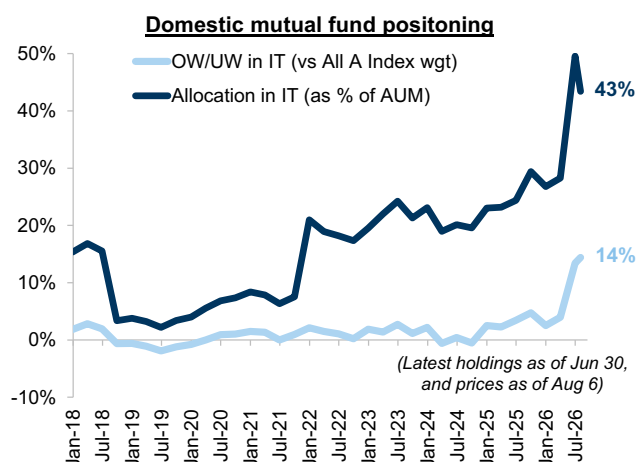
Domestic mutual fund industry has amassed close to Rmb40tn of AUM, of which Rmb7tn is allocated to equities, accounting for 6.6%/15% of the total outstanding/free-float market cap. Cash ratios for equity mutual funds have edged higher amid the market gyrations, but their **allocations to and positioning (i.e. over- or underweight) in Tech equities** (including Semiconductors, Hardware and Software companies that are exposed to the AI theme) **still hover at historical peak levels**. Systematic investors or strategies, which have grown significantly in size and turnover representation in A shares in the past few years, may have gone through a **deeper de-leveraging or risk-reduction process** as reflected by the falling cash trading and funding spreads in the small-mid-cap cohort, both of which are commonly-followed proxies for quant funds' activity levels in A shares.

Exhibit 17: Domestic equity mutual fund managers have cut equity risks moderately...



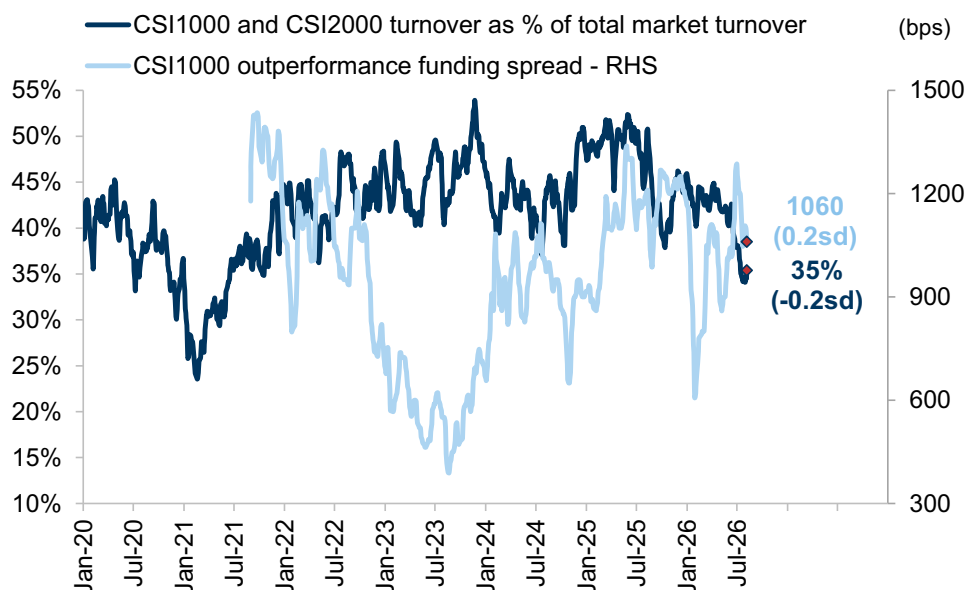
Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: ...but are still heavily exposed to Tech equities in their portfolios



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: Activity level of quant strategies in A shares seems to have slowed recently

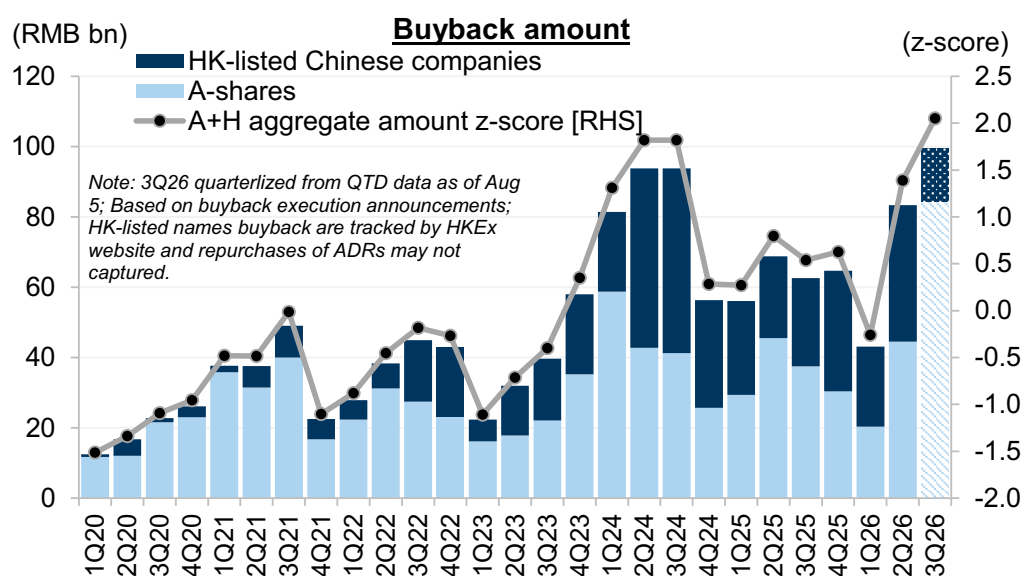


Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

7) Corporate actions from listed companies

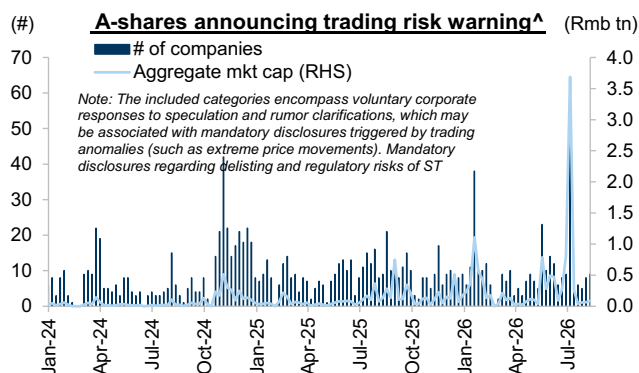
Corporate actions are often a leading indicator of equity returns. As such, we gauge the risk of further market correction via 3 corporate action channels—buybacks, trading warnings, and insider selling/buying. First, **stock repurchases have reached multi-year highs** in 3Q26 (quarterized), up 35% and 59% yoy in announced buyback deals and buyback amount (with the treasury shares being canceled in some cases), reflecting high management confidence in the company's intrinsic value. Second, **excessive price movement and abnormal trading warnings** from listed companies also surged in June before the correction, but has fallen substantially since then. Lastly, selling from significant shareholders and company executives across all listed A-share companies has returned to **more balanced levels, improving from net selling territory** for the most part in 1H26.

Exhibit 20: Share buybacks reached recent-year highs in 3Q26



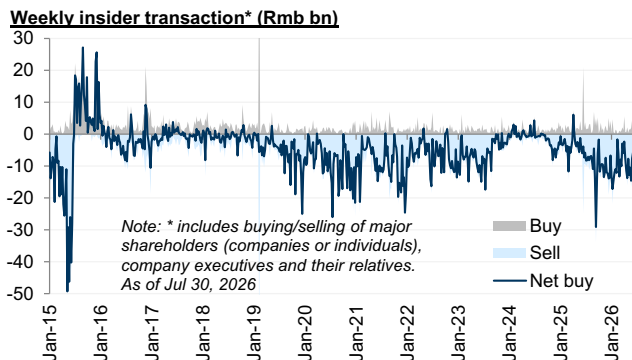
Source: Wind, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 21: Excessive price and trading risk warnings from listed companies surged before the correction but have fallen significantly since then



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 22: Net equity selling from major shareholders and executives has returned to more balanced territory

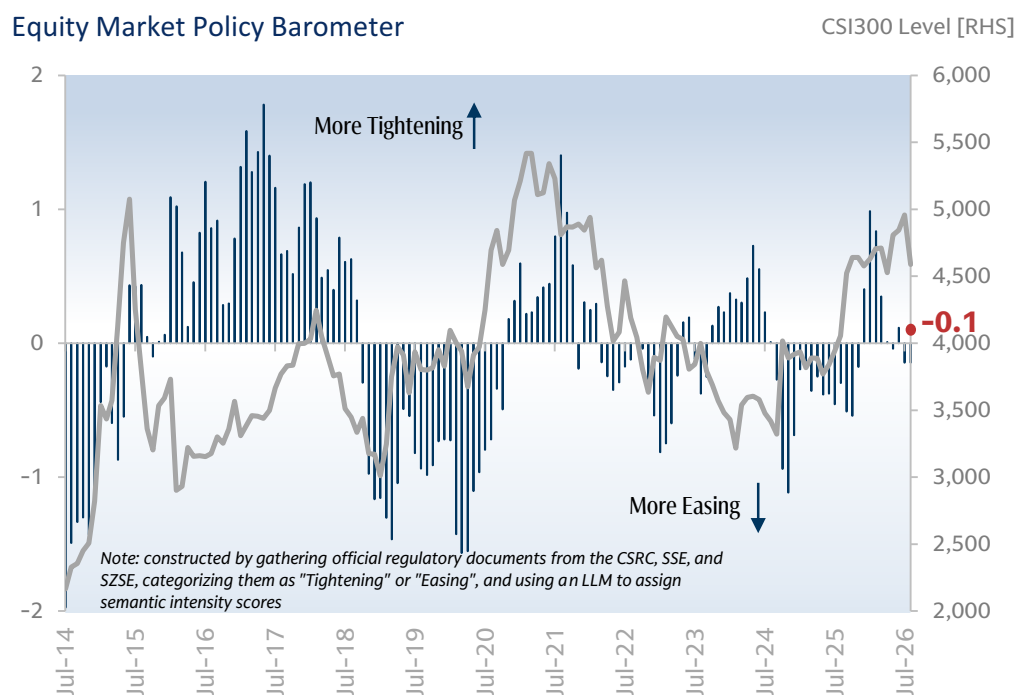


Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

8) Policy rhetoric and stance on the equity market

Abrupt policy tightening measures were often a key reason for market reversal in previous China equity bull runs, notably the leverage unwind sell-off in 2015 and the regulatory tightening towards the private sector in late 2020. By the same token, policy actions and signals, and policymakers' attitude/language towards the equity market have triggered many powerful equity rallies in history, including the 9/24 "policy pivot" 2 years ago. Similar to many of our text-based analytical tools, we dissect and interpret policy statements and regulators' public announcements systematically using our large-language-model (LLM), which enables us to quantify policy risk and support in both frequency and magnitude terms. This exercise leads us to believe that **policymakers' perceived market overheating and the resulting policy tightening risks indeed reached a cycle peak in 1Q26 but have since fallen back to a more neutral range.**

Exhibit 23: Equity market policy stance seems to be tightened in recent months

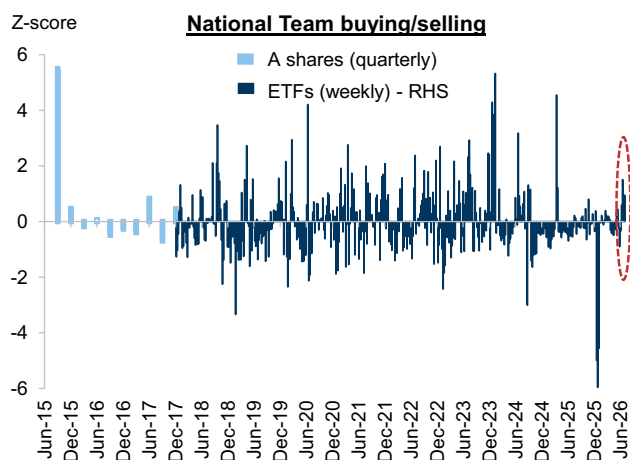


Source: CSRC, SSE, SZSE, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

9) The Chinese National team

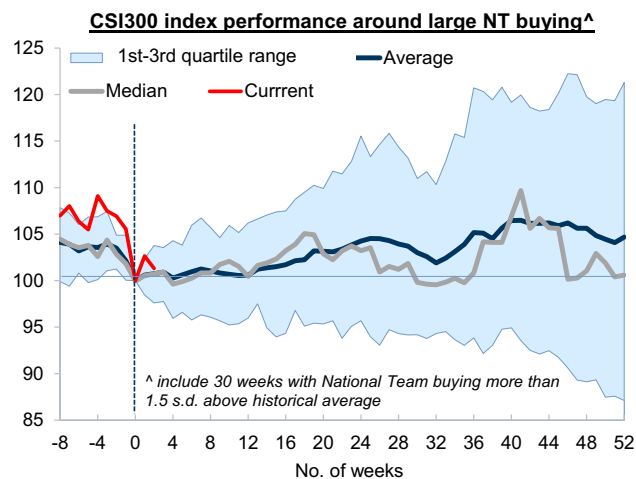
Established in the aftermath of the 2015 market fall, the broadly-defined Chinese National Team currently holds around Rmb5tn worth of A-share equities on our estimate, mostly in single-stock holdings, equivalent to 5% of the total outstanding listed A-share market cap. Historically, it has acted as a counter-cyclical stabilizer to onshore equities, effectively underwriting a downside put to investors when the market is under stress. But when equity returns are strong and valuations are deemed as less compelling, the National Team has shown no hesitation of selling into strength and taking profit. Per our National Team tracker, we estimate that **it has net bought more than Rmb140bn worth of A-share equities, including modest buying of STAR50 ETFs, in the past 3 weeks, after selling about Rmb1.5tn in the prior 6 months**. Importantly, the scale of National Team's buying has historically been well correlated with subsequent market returns, with large-scale intervention (>1.5 s.d. in weekly net purchases) typically marking a medium-term bottom for the broader market.

Exhibit 24: The National Team has turned into a net buyer of A-share equities in recent weeks



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 25: Empirically, large (>1.5 s.d.) NT buying tended to correlate with decent market returns in the ensuing months

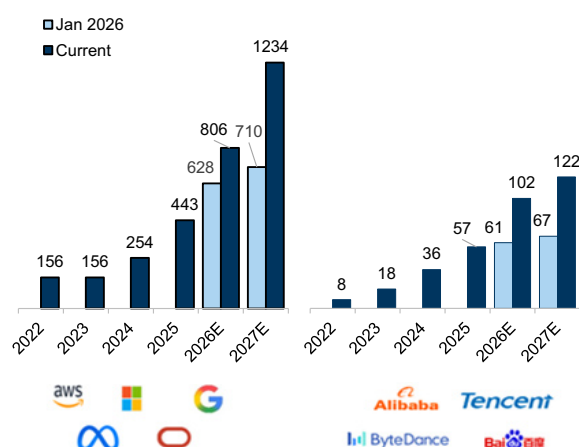


Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

10) Capex and earnings revisions

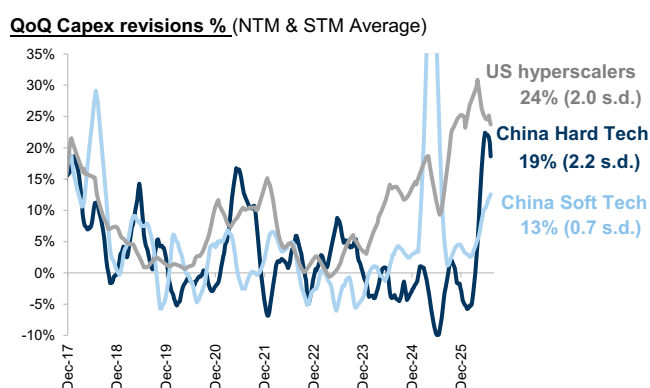
Fundamentally, the AI capex boom globally is the fuel behind the outsized gains of AI-related stocks in China and abroad—on GS estimates, **total AI expenditures from 9 major US and Chinese hyperscalers/CSPs could top US\$900bn this year and US\$1.3tn next**, 1.7% and 2.3% of the combined US and China GDP. The outlays have ushered in powerful revenue and earnings impulses that ripple through the global AI value-added chain, spanning Korean memory names, Taiwanese foundry, Japanese semi materials and equipment suppliers, and Chinese tech firms in the Power and Infra cohorts. 2026 and 2027 consensus capex for the top-8 listed US and Chinese hyperscalers has indeed been raised by 32% and 75% ytd, in large part contributing to the 12%/22% FY26/27 profit upgrade in the Hard Tech cohort in the first 7 months of the year. That said, **the 2nd derivative of consensus capex growth would subsequently impact the trajectory of Hard Tech companies' profit growth profile**. As such, the capex guidance and AI development/monetization roadmap by Chinese and US hyperscalers in the forthcoming results season will be consequential in framing the AI narrative and investment strategy in the months ahead.

Exhibit 26: Consensus capex expectations for US and China hyperscalers have been revised up significantly ytd



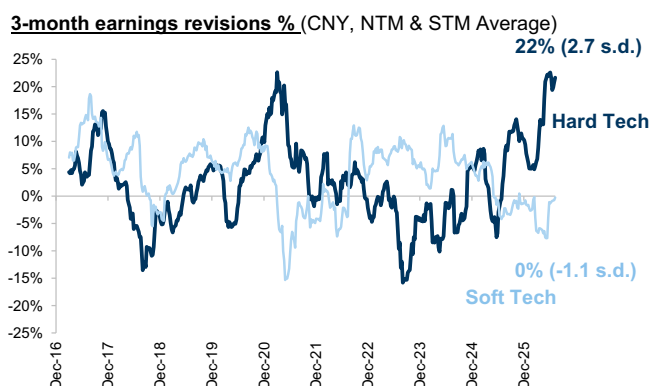
Source: FactSet, IBES, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 27: Capex revision momentum has started to slow from a high base



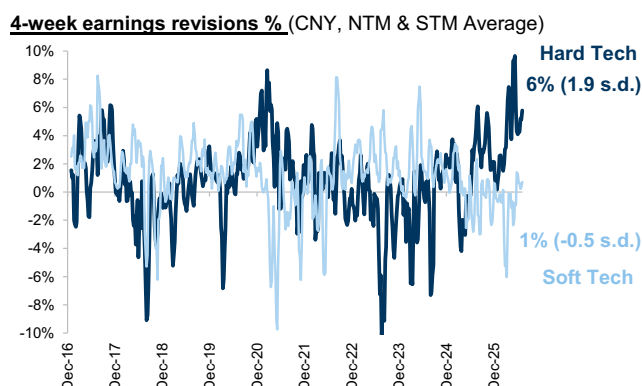
Source: FactSet, IBES, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 28: Earnings revisions momentum for Chinese Hard Tech seems to have peaked at least in the short term...



Source: FactSet, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 29: ...while that for Soft Tech may have room to improve cyclically

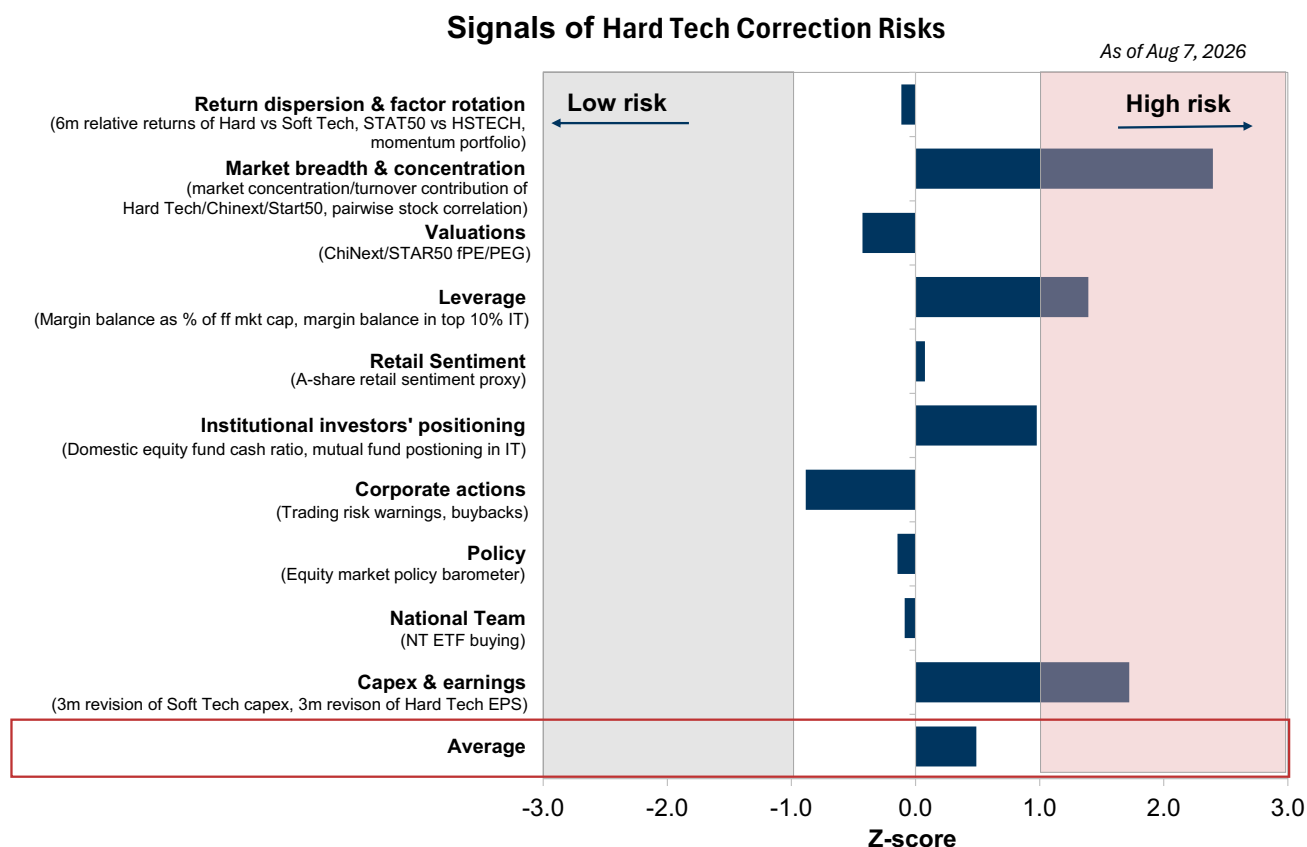


Source: FactSet, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Bottom-line: Rotation and diversification in focus

In sum, the above 10 indicators and signals suggest to us that a decent portion of the prior speculative length, valuation excess, leverage, and positioning concentration risk in Chinese AI Hard Tech has been compressed alongside the price correction cycle. With the fundamental case for AI and other liquidity trends remaining solid, we **maintain our constructive view on A shares (Overweight)** and the AI Hard Tech bias there on a structural basis.

Exhibit 30: We compiled 10 indicators to signal potential Hard Tech correction risks



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

But, the latest drawdown has underscored importance of portfolio diversification in a volatile market where return correlations across asset classes, markets, and sectors are elevated. Specifically, we like the following 4 strategies to expose to idiosyncrasy and to potentially improve portfolios' Sharpe ratios within the Chinese equity universe:

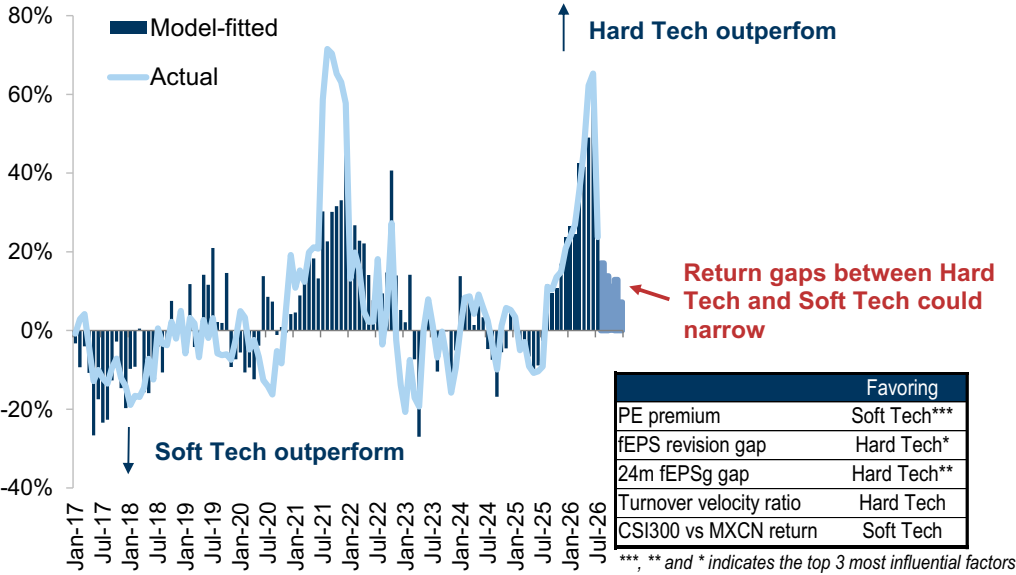
- 1. Scaling into select H-share Soft Tech:** As detailed in our recent report—Rotation Temptation—the tactical investment case for Offshore Internet and Soft Tech equities has turned incrementally more compelling, underpinned by their: a) substantial underperformance and wide relative return gaps vs. the Hard Tech peers; b) cycle-trough valuations which might have already discounted a fair amount of AI capex, regulatory, earnings risks; c) narrowing subsidy losses in the food delivery/instant consumption businesses; and, d) improving momentum in AI

monetization trends revolving around cloud, agentic AI, and token consumption. Our Hard vs Soft Tech Rotation Model indeed suggests that the latter could further recoup some of its underperformance in the months ahead.

2. **Policy beneficiaries in both the AI and non AI spaces:** While AI (development) is arguably a top priority for Chinese policymakers due to national security and growth considerations, their agenda is comprehensive and goes beyond just AI and Tech, notably biotech/pharma, services consumption, advanced manufacturing, and agriculture. Broadly, our 15th FYP portfolio, which features 50 select names in both the AI and non-AI categories that are well-aligned with strategic policy objectives in the 15th FYP, has continued to perform well in absolute return and Sharpe ratio terms despite heightened market volatility. In the AI space, besides owning a well-diversified portfolio along the extended AI value-added chain (e.g. our **Select AI Portfolio**), self-sufficiency (exports substitution/localization) should be a continued theme for investors to participate in the structural growth story of AI while adding diversification benefits to their AI-centric portfolios, as reflected by the **notable outperformance of domestic-oriented AI names vs. those that are mostly export-focused in the latest sell-off**.
3. **Earnings back in the driver's seat.** The relatively deep reversal of the EPS momentum factor vis-a-vis the Hard vs Soft Tech thematic divide indicates that some growthy names with solid earnings backing have been more severely impacted in this broad-based valuation and positioning reset than would otherwise be warranted by fundamentals. In Exhibit 34, we screen for **GS Buy-rated Tech and non-Tech names with above-sector average upward earnings revisions** in the past 1 month but trade at or below mid-cycle to re-engage the earnings delivery theme in the lead-up to the 2Q26/interim results season.
4. **Looking for alpha in the IPO market, and cash from the Shareholder Returns theme.** New IPOs in HK/China generally are still an efficient way for investors to generate alpha and uncorrelated returns at least in the short-term, with all new issuances across A- and H-share on median delivering 75% and 68% 1- and 3-month gains post listing ytd. While not as growthy and explosive as the AI story, the shareholder returns theme has weathered the correction cycle well, reinforcing our long-standing view that it should be a core part of investors' portfolio, especially on our forecast that total cash returns to shareholders from listed Chinese corporates via dividends and buybacks could top Rmb4tn (another all-time high) in FY26.

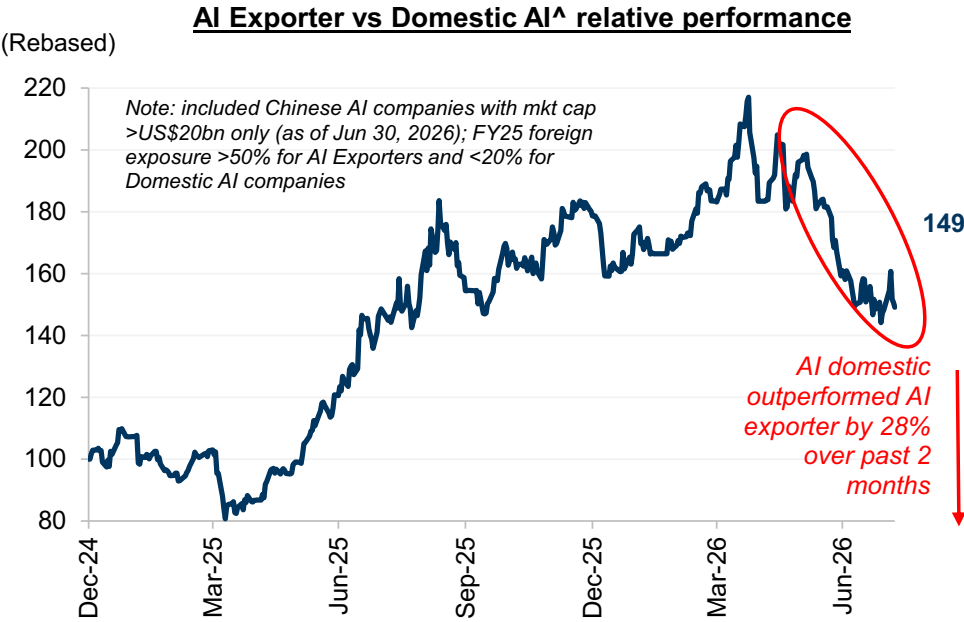
Exhibit 31: Soft Tech equities may further close its underperformance gaps vs Hard Tech proxies in the coming months

MSCI China AI Hard Tech vs Soft Tech Relative Returns (rolling 6 months)



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 32: Domestic-focused AI companies have outperformed those that are export-oriented in the latest AI correction episode



Source: FactSet, Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 33: A list of Chinese AI exporters and domestic-focused companies

		>50%	>20			<20%	>20
		Foreign sales %	Market cap (USD bn)			Foreign sales %	Market cap (USD bn)
AI exporter				Domestic AI			
300308 CS	Zhongji Innolight	91%	156	688256 CG	Cambricon	<5%	148
300502 CS	Eoptolink	96%	125	688981 CG	SMIC	15%	128
002475 CS	Luxshare	85%	75	002371 CS	NAURA	<5%	95
002384 CS	Dongshan Precision	81%	71	688347 CG	Hua Hong	18%	57
688008 CG	Montage	71%	57	300408 CS	Three-Circle	<5%	46
300476 CS	Victory Giant	77%	49	688012 CG	AMEC	<5%	43
300394 CS	TFC Communication	75%	49	688072 CG	Piotech	<5%	35
000725 CS	BOE	50%	47	688498 CG	Yuanjie	<5%	34
002463 CS	WUS Printed Circuit	82%	43	300604 CS	Changchuan	16%	32
300433 CS	Lens Technology	55%	40	688082 CG	ACM Research	<5%	31
300274 CS	Sungrow	61%	37	600522 CG	Zhongtian	17%	31
992 HK	Lenovo	77%	36	601985 CG	CNNP	<5%	27
002938 CS	Avary Holding	84%	36	000988 CS	Huagong Tech	14%	27
000338 CS	Weichai Power	53%	35	600406 CG	NARI Technology	9%	27
688525 CG	Biwin Storage	53%	34	003816 CS	CGN Power	8%	26
301308 CS	Longsys	67%	29	300124 CS	Inovance	6%	24
600584 CG	JCET	79%	27	688120 CG	Hwatsing	<5%	23
300857 CS	Sharetronic	51%	25	601100 CG	Hengli Hydraulic	19%	21
001309 CS	Techwinsemi	64%	22	600160 CG	Juhua	<5%	21

Note: Prices as of Jun 30, 2026; Foreign sales exposure based on FY25 or latest estimates

Source: Wind, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 34: GS Buy-rated hard tech and non-hard tech names with positive earnings revisions in the past 3 months

Either ≥+3										<50%tile		B/B*	
Ticker	Name	GICS Industry Group	Quoted Price	Quoted Ccy	Total listed Mkt Cap (US\$bn)	ADVT (US\$mn)	25-27E EPS CAGR (%)	26E 3M Earnings Revision (%)	27E 3M Earnings Revision (%)	27E P/E (X)	12m fPE 5yr %tile	Price vs YTD High	GS Ratings
GS Buy-rated China AI hard tech stocks with recent EPS upgrades and below mid-cycle multiples													
688012 CG	AMEC	Semiconductors	358	CNY	51	1198	48	+7	+5	55.4	29	-24%	B
992 HK	Lenovo	Tech Hardware	26	HKD	42	312	34	+46	+51	16.2	41	-1%	B
603986 CG	GigaDevice	Semiconductors	385	CNY	38	3082	122	+70	+71	43.2	35	-54%	B
688008 CG	Montage Technology	Semiconductors	212	CNY	36	1951	48	+8	+17	48.5	32	-33%	B
000338 CS	Weichai Power	Capital Goods	30	CNY	30	516	28	+1	+4	14.2	40	-14%	B
300124 CS	Inovance	Capital Goods	64	CNY	23	383	20	+1	+3	24.3	19	-20%	B*
688521 CG	VeriSilicon	Semiconductors	215	CNY	17	882	-	+9	+14	92.8	44	-42%	B
600885 CG	Hongfa Technology	Capital Goods	36	CNY	8	108	22	+6	+8	20.9	43	-5%	B
GS Buy-rated China non-hard tech stocks with recent EPS upgrades and below mid-cycle multiples													
9999 HK	Netease	Media	203	HKD	83	193	12	+5	+5	12.3	50	-12%	B*
9618 HK	JD.com	Retail	130	HKD	41	171	34	+5	+5	8.1	30	0%	B
600309 CG	Wanhua Chemical	Materials	74	CNY	35	452	29	+6	+8	10.9	41	-21%	B
2423 HK	KE Holdings	Real Estate	45	HKD	19	69	41	+22	+19	14.5	28	-14%	B
000776 CS	GF Securities	Financial Services	21	CNY	19	229	17	+8	+4	8.4	44	-14%	B
9987 HK	Yum China	Consumer Services	379	HKD	17	40	15	+2	+3	14.4	23	-16%	B*
2057 HK	ZTO Express	Transportation	191	HKD	14	45	20	+6	+7	11.5	19	-6%	B
600436 CG	Pientzehuang	Pharmaceuticals	137	CNY	12	87	12	+3	+4	33.8	0	-21%	B
2359 HK	WuXi AppTec	Pharmaceuticals	184	HKD	12	99	18	+24	+25	19.3	32	0%	B*
9901 HK	New Oriental	Consumer Services	45	HKD	9	25	19	+4	+4	14.0	24	-12%	B
YMM UN	Full Truck Alliance	Transportation	10	USD	9	68	18	+6	+3	11.2	20	-17%	B
3998 HK	Bosideng	Apparel	5	HKD	7	16	10	+7	+3	11.0	25	-1%	B
3908 HK	CICC	Financial Services	22	HKD	5	43	33	+9	+10	6.6	40	-4%	B
TAL UN	TAL Education	Consumer Services	12	USD	5	42	19	+57	+20	11.3	2	-6%	B
1199 HK	COSCO SHIPPING Ports	Transportation	5	HKD	3	3	5	+1	+7	7.5	49	-21%	B
6699 HK	Angelalign	HC Equipment	95	HKD	2	7	21	+15	+22	38.8	0	-2%	B
3323 HK	CNBM	Materials	4	HKD	2	46	-	+1	+6	3.9	11	-43%	B
603882 CG	Kingmed Diagnostics	HC Equipment	28	CNY	2	24	-	+15	+3	25.5	31	-25%	B
601038 CG	First Tractor	Capital Goods	14	CNY	1	17	19	+1	+9	13.1	36	-15%	B
300685 CS	Amoy Diagnostics	Pharmaceuticals	18	CNY	1	29	18	+4	+4	15.3	1	-25%	B
1789 HK	AK Medical	HC Equipment	6	HKD	1	4	24	+4	+4	11.4	7	-20%	B
Median					12	69	20	+6	+6	14.2	30	-15%	

Note: Prices as of Aug 5, 2026; 27E P/E, and ratings are based on GS sector analysts' view; B=Buy. * indicates conviction list. We keep one ticker for dual-listed stocks.

Source: Wind, FactSet, Bloomberg, IBES, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Appendix

Exhibit 35: Key words we analyze in our Policy Risk Barometer

Policy Direction	Intensity Level	Target Score	Chinese Keywords / Phrases	English Translation	Regulatory Context & Justification
Tightening	Extreme	1	暂停IPO / 暂缓新股发行	Suspend IPOs	High-impact administrative interventions that freeze primary market financing, forcibly deleverage the secondary market, or restrict major shareholders' liquidity.
			清理场外配资 / 伞形信托	Clear OTC margin lending	
			实施熔断机制	Implement circuit breakers	
	Moderate	0.5	最严减持新规 / 限制减持	Strictest share reduction ban	Targeted restrictive measures aimed at cooling down speculative trading, reducing leverage, or punishing specific market misconduct.
			提高融资保证金比例	Raise margin requirements	
			限制高频量化交易 / 异常交易	Restrict high-frequency quant trading	
Easing	Mild	0.1	严查带病申报 / 现场检查	Strict IPO onsite inspections	Routine supervisory actions, disclosure enhancements, and administrative inquiries with low immediate liquidity impact.
			立案调查 / 顶格处罚	Filing investigation / Maximum penalty	
			发布合规指引 / 问询函	Issue compliance guidelines / Inquiries	
	Moderate	-0.5	加强信息披露监管	Strengthen disclosure supervision	Structural reforms designed to boost market liquidity, encourage corporate restructuring, and expand the institutional investor base.
			规范日常运作	Normalize daily operations	
			保持常态化发行	Maintain normalized IPO issuance	
Neutral	Neutral	0	日常人事变动	Routine personnel changes	Standard administrative procedures, regular market operations, or neutral structural updates.
			发布年度工作报告	Publish annual reports	
			减价上市费用 / 经手费	Reduce listing / transaction fees	
	Mild	-0.1	优化跨境资格互认	Optimize cross-border recognition	Minor cost-reduction measures or incremental operational improvements that marginally lower friction for market participants.
			常规制度优化	Routine institutional optimization	
			放宽两融标的范围	Broaden margin trading targets	
Easing	Moderate	-0.5	简化并购重组审批	Simplify M&A approvals	Heavyweight, systemic interventions that directly inject massive liquidity, lower transaction taxes, or deploy state capital to stabilize the market.
			引导中长期资金入市	Guide long-term funds into market	
			支持红筹企业回归	Support red-chip listings	
	Extreme	-1	减半征收证券交易印花税	Halve securities stamp duty	
			国家队直接入市 / 汇金增持	National Team direct buying	
			创设证券基金保险公司互换便利	Establish SFISF swap facility	

Source: CSRC, SSE, SZSE, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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